

Contact

www.linkedin.com/in/estrella-orellana-padilla (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Resiliency

Upselling

Typographic Layout

Languages

English (Native or Bilingual)

Spanish (Native or Bilingual)

Honors-Awards

The President's Volunteer Service Award

Estrella Orellana Padilla

Visual Storyteller | Design Studies Student at San Jose State University | Class of 2029
United States

Summary

Hi, I'm Estrella! I am an incoming transfer junior at San José State University majoring in Design Studies, with a deep focus on storytelling and digital art. My creative journey started at five years old when I fell in love with storytelling. Back in elementary school, it became a tradition of mine to visit the library, check out a high stack of books, and spend my days reading book after book. Throughout middle school, high school, and community college, I noticed that I always paid the most attention in my writing and drawing classes. Engaging in traditional art and creative writing simply felt like home to me. Lately, as I've transitioned into digital layout and composition, I've found that same passion. It's the kind of work where I completely lose track of time. As a designer, my strengths lie in bridging the gap between text and visuals. I combine my foundational studio art background with modern tools like Canva and Adobe Photoshop to create engaging typography layouts and promotional designs. I am actively seeking introductory roles and internship opportunities that combine creative writing and visual design. I am especially motivated to apply my skills toward visual communication and storytelling for vital causes, including mental health advocacy, LGBTQ+ rights, and housing affordability. My target roles include introductory positions in Content Design, Junior Visual Designer, and Visual Storytelling, where I can collaborate on narrative-driven projects. Let's connect! Whether you want to discuss design, creative writing, or potential student opportunities, I invite you to reach out.

Experience

Braven

Fellow

June 2026 - Present (2 months)

Develop workforce skills such as leadership, operating and managing, communicating and networking, working in teams, and problem solving by completing a 14-week leadership and professional development course.

Personal Mockup Project: The Neighborhood Concert Poster

Independent Graphic Designer

March 2026 - May 2026 (3 months)

Santa Clara, CA

- Produced a highly cohesive final layout and poster design by embedding a system of 3 scaled accent vectors from foundational iterations on Canva, by successfully arranging an intricate balance of 4 3D geometric shapes and asymmetrical element alignments.
- Designed a comprehensive band poster concept by producing 5 digital variations to finalize 1 optimized layout in Canva, through translating analog sketch annotations and 6 rapid typography layouts to maximize text clarity.
- Translated the band's core logo, color palette, and geometric simplicity into a unified visual branding identity by designing a poster that perfectly represented their aesthetic across 9 distinct graphic components, through strategically pairing graphic elements with high-contrast text and inversion colors.

California's Great America

3 years 5 months

Team Lead in Food & Beverage Department

May 2024 - October 2025 (1 year 6 months)

Santa Clara, CA

- Maintained food facility operations and 100% goal completion within a high-traffic amusement park by ensuring peak-demand readiness and identifying immediate service needs, through collaborating with 6+ coworkers, 4+ management, and resolving escalations for 40+ customers daily.
- Fostered a positive, high-morale shift culture for 6+ coworkers by optimizing service speed and team cohesion, through implementing a continuous feedback structure that balanced personal recognition with actionable coaching.
- Managed a primary food facility while coordinating with 3 separate, external departments by preserving total team organization, developing training plans, and delegating tasks to 6+ coworkers, through partnering with respective

building management to sync inventory, manage cross-facility coverage, and provide adaptable shift support.

Associate in Food & Beverage Department

June 2022 - May 2024 (2 years)

Multitasked across multiple operational stations, stepped in to guide the team during understaffed shifts, and successfully passed 10+ consecutive secret shopper audits for excellent upselling.

De Anza College

Student Member, School Project: Pattern Intervention

February 2025 - March 2025 (2 months)

Cupertino, CA

- Created a balanced 8.5"x8.5" paper pattern tile by executing a manual cut-and-rotate method to seamlessly rearrange four equal canvas quadrants, through meticulously refining pencil sketches with ink tracing and clear tape grid alignment.

- Digitized hand-colored artwork into a print-ready file by capturing high-resolution physical designs and processing them within Adobe Photoshop, while ensuring color accuracy through strict RGB and CMYK formatting standards.

- Generated a seamless repeating digital pattern from a single physical artwork source by utilizing Adobe Photoshop's pattern generation tools, while enhancing visual depth through a custom solid-color adjustment layer.

Education

San José State University

Bachelor of Arts in Design Studies, Design Studies · (2026 - May 2029)

De Anza College

Associate of Arts, Liberal Arts · (September 2022 - June 2025)